

Belarus

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** May 16, 1995 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red and white are traditional Belarussian colors



Red and green were the colors of Belarus's flag while it was a Soviet republic

A national ornament representing woven cloth

Europe



Belarus, formerly White Russia, became independent of the USSR in 1991, although its ties with Russia are increasing once more.

The original flag of Belarus while under Soviet administration in 1922 was similar to that of the USSR. It was changed in 1951, and the flag used today is similar to this second flag, except that the communist hammer, sickle, and star have been removed, and the red and white portions of the hoist ornamentation have been reversed.

THE REJECTED DESIGN

Following independence from the USSR in 1991, Belarus adopted a flag of three equal horizontal stripes of white-red-white. This was the same flag which had been associated with a brief period of Belarussian independence in 1918 and its colors

were derived from the arms of the republic. The design was rejected in a referendum in 1995.

The flag of Belarus adopted following the referendum, reflects its growing ties with Russia. The unusual ornamentation in the hoist is described as a national ornament and represents woven cloth.

ARMS OF BELARUS

The Soviet-style coat of arms, retained on independence, also reflects the dominant Russian influence. This depicts an outline of the state against a sun rising from behind a globe. This is entirely surrounded by wreaths of wheat and flowers.